

SPINE v2.0: THE FABLE LOOP · from 2026-09-13

Stephen's instruction: run Fable against the spine until it returns happy (PROCEED, PROCEED WITH CHANGES or TEST BEFORE COMMITTING), then run GPT. Rule of the loop: every finding is answered from facts already in the world or with a row that pays a character's choice; anything that would need a ruling (premise, foundations, the clock's turns, a character's choice not already ruled) is held for Stephen and listed here. Each round's review is filed verbatim; each answer is a numbered point release of the spine.

Round 1 → v2.0.2

Review: episode-1-spine-four-keys-v2.0-attack-fable-r1-2026-09-13.md. Verdict REWORK of rows, not of the device.

Front	Finding	Answer	Kind
1	The panel was in the workshop roof and the workshop has two keys, so the sum closes on Brad; she never does it; five weeks of not showing him is suspicion or convenience	The loft over the racks runs the length of the row of units behind the fish market, boarded from every unit and the market's store, used by nobody (A1 –380, D1, G); Violet does that sum on Day –75 and it closes on nobody (A1 –75). She shows Brad last out of pride, paid: her alphabet done better than she can, and he is her pupil (A1 –70)	World fact + paid row. Judgement call flagged for Stephen: the shared loft is a new fact about the workshop
2	Repaid is falsifiable where forgiven is not; the box lie is unmotivated	Repaid not forgiven by calculation: a debt let go in a letter is still a debt to the estate, and the sister's solicitor would write to him; repaid is money gone (C2 Week 3). The box lie: since seven invites and you went there alone, and he had (A2 17:30)	World logic
3	Where did she put the repaid money; the barrel was counted; who fitted the lock	The barrel went to the sister sealed by HCPD and logged by weight, never counted in front of anyone; Margo's figure for it is four years old and spent down (A2 Day 5). Ruby: in the barrel, where else (A3 Day 33). She fitted the cylinder herself; the locksmith cut from a key and never saw the house (A1 –35, A3 Day 15)	World facts
4	Margo shrugs for thirty-seven days at a missing receivables ledger	Her position since Day –2000 written and paid: a cash gift that refused paper is not a business receivable; her note is a conversation she was not instructed to act on; no estate accountant exists until about Day 40; nobody asks until Day 45 and she then answers in full (A2 Day 8, C5)	Paid row
5	Day 311 airs the boat owner, against F10; Ally's "the letter had been in his hands" is unsourced	Day 311 rewritten: only what Ally can source airs (the slip, the survivors' reading times, Brad's box habit, his quarter-to-six line); the sighting stays with Del and is why she believes what she airs; the café aired without a name; inference said as inference	Document fix
6	Foundation 1's "unenforceable" is really "thinly papered, written off"	Header wording changed to written off by the sister's solicitor on Day 55	Wording

Held for Stephen: the shared loft (front 1) is the one new world fact this round introduced; everything else is a row or a wording.

Round 2 → v2.0.3

Review: episode-1-spine-four-keys-v2.0-attack-fable-r2-2026-09-13.md. **Verdict PROCEED WITH CHANGES**, high confidence the device holds and every finding is answered by a row. The loop's exit condition is met; the changes are applied and the spine is frozen for GPT.

Front	Finding	Answer	Kind
1	The loft answers where the panel lay, not whose hand; two hands on the coast can write her alphabet, so the -75 sum closes and she is written as if it does not	The -75 row is a refusal, not a failure: she writes "half the market" in order not to write "two hands, and I am one", and it is the same refusal as Day -29, paid at the same price. Liam sees the new cylinder on Day -35 and she says the old one was sticking	Paid row. Flagged for Stephen: Violet now knowingly refuses a sum that points at Brad, which is foundation 3's refusal extended to the panel
2	Brad has no route to the fact that the four get the keys on her death, and foundation 2 stands on that hour; the box lie is claimed coherent and is not; the repaid-not-forgiven reason is the wrong one	She tells him at the store door: if anything happens to me you four get the keys and my sister gets a padlock (A1 -19; row 16a; C2). The box lie owned as the one act against his interest, and the tell (A2; C2 verdict; F2). The truer reason for repaid added: forgiven is a louder lie to Margo's ear	Row + owned exception
3	Ruby holds Brad's marathon lie and would say it at meeting 4; the room then holds a man who was leaving; Day 62 becomes voluntary disappearance	Meeting 4 written: Ruby says it, Brad answers, the room hears vanity not flight for two stated reasons, Ruby's cost paid, Liam keeps the crane-cab question because Brad is his only defender. Day 62: why nobody says voluntary. Row 30 carries the key taken in	Paid rows
4	Margo asks what cash was found; the barrel's count against the van sum is a decisive small number the document never states; the Civic Row account was not yet due; the -120 list in Violet's hand is real paper	The count asked, given, computed to nothing against a stale baseline (A3 Day 45; 33d; F13). The account demoted: not due is not unpaid. The -120 list is Margo's own note of a conversation, not Violet's hand. Margo's arrival owned as the moment the reading acquires cost and shape, standing on the book alone	World facts + honesty
5	Ally airs "eleven hours nobody has accounted for" while holding the boat owner's account; key-from-seven stated as fact; Margo's time unsourced; postmark and box lobby	The false sentence replaced by the on-air ask; the habit said as habit; Margo's time as Ruby's memory of her call; posted after the Friday collection; the box lobby opens at seven (G)	Wording
6	The solicitor "advised police" and "could tell nobody": the uncomputed route ends the episode in week 4	The cheap fix: she told him nothing but the instruction; he holds no fear; his Day 6 route to the coroner's officer is computed and empty (C1 -3; row 16; C8)	World fact, computed

Held for Stephen: front 1's extension of the refusal to the panel. Everything else is a row.

Round 3 (confirmation, at Stephen's request) → v2.0.4

Review: episode-1-spine-four-keys-v2.0-attack-fable-r3-2026-09-13.md. **Verdict PROCEED WITH CHANGES**, high confidence the changes are rows and not machinery. Answered.

Front	Finding	Answer	Kind
6 (driver)	The world says a book of everything she fetched to show people, and rules a book nobody knew; Ruby would ask where her book was	Written upstairs at night, alone; nobody but Violet had seen or heard of it before Day 0; Liam's twenty years of letting himself in were downstairs and daytime; Brad watched her go up for it on Day 0, the first time it was fetched for anyone; Margo knew because Violet told her the loan was written in it (G; row 20; Day 62)	Paid world fact
1	One copy of the letter on a morning full of redundancy; the telling at the store door reads bolted on; the will	One copy by decision: a copy in a solicitor's file is a document the sister's people can demand, and the four read it together or not at all (A1 –19; C1 –3). The telling written as the third refusal on the Day –600 fact: he is the only one she talks to about the other three, and to keep it from him is to let him be the second hand. The will raised and deferred	Paid rows
2	The box lie as a reflex on the one question he had fourteen days to prepare for; the corridor (a board, two carries, the tube out and back); the date arithmetic	A costed mistake: Liam rings, not Ruby, and says mine only came tonight, have you seen yours; Brad matches him, and hears it as he says it (A2; C2 verdict; F2). The panel wrapped, one carry; the tube never leaves the store (A2; D2). Mid August to the end of November, the December hearing	Rows
3	"Again" has no antecedent once the tin is cut; nothing on the list about Margo	A bland first incident in her voice (the yard gate unbolted in October) gives again its antecedent (D3; row 30; Day 26). A bland Margo item so the list has one on each	Rows
4	Margo's fourth route, Ruby alone, uncomputed; the barrel baseline wording; her Day 45 omission of the letter	Computed: Ruby cannot hold a thing without saying it in the room, and Margo has known that twenty years; her withdrawal from Ruby from Day 54 is the cost (C5). Baseline wording fixed. The omission owned as her second, paid	Paid rows
5	"All three who knew him" with two survivors alive; the sort time unsourced; Ruby's two-hour wait; posting day	Two survivors; the counter clerk on the record that the overnight sort is in the boxes before seven (A5 Day 311; row 62; G). Ruby sits with hers and rings Liam at five; Liam rings Brad. Posted Friday evening after the last collection	Wordings + one source
6 (cosmetic)	The skipper and the dry bag; the boat owner and the front page	The skipper never knew where the papers were kept; the boat owner's Day 265 route to Del computed to the same nothing	Rows

Held for Stephen: nothing new this round beyond the two already flagged (the shared loft; Violet's refusal extended to the panel and, now, to the telling at the store door, all three as one refusal).

Exit

Three rounds. Round 1 REWORK of rows; rounds 2 and 3 PROCEED WITH CHANGES with high confidence the device holds. Every finding answered from the world or paid as a row; none needed a ruling. Spine v2.0.4 is frozen for GPT.